

CPU

The CPU (Central Processing Unit) is where all the calculations happen and is essentially the heart of your PC. Intel and AMD battle it out for your attention in this space.

Intel

Intel's current lineup consists of the "Core i" series. Under that we have three brackets dividing the processors based on usage scenarios. The Core-i3 is the entry level bracket, then comes the mid-range Core i5 series and finally the Core i7 series for enthusiasts. Along with the above mentioned series exist certain other lineups which are equally popular - Atom, Pentium and Celeron. While the Celeron is nowhere to be seen nowadays the other two are well and alive. Pentium is geared towards the lower spectrum of the mid-range and the Atom processors are ultra low power processors used in netbooks.

AMD

AMD on the other hand has the Phenom II Series, Athlon II Series and more recently the Fusion and Bulldozer series. All these series have processors for all three market brackets. What is new is that when AMD bought ATI it gained access to good GPU technology, naturally they combined their CPU technology with the other to create the Fusion processors. As a result, the Fusion series has a much powerful on-chip graphics processor.